

Tea Cover & Matching Mat

HAND-PIECED PATCHWORK · A NAMED SET

✓ **THE MAT IS MEASURED AND CONFIRMED** (2026-09-29) — everything in the left column is real. **The cover is 12" × 9"**, which is published. What is still read off photographs is only the inside of the cover, and it sits in the boxes bottom right. ❌ **The provisional sheet said the mat was bound in cream. It is not bound at all** — corrected.

The mat CONFIRMED

12" × 12" 9 5" ½" none
FINISHED SQUARES · 3 × 3 CUT SIZE OF EACH SEAM THROUGHOUT BINDING · TURNED INSTEAD

🧵 **CONFIRM THE ½" ONCE.** It is the only seam that lands on 12", so it is almost certainly right: **3 × 5" = 15"**, less two ½" seams = a **13" panel**, less ½" all round when it is turned = **12"**. A ¼" quilting seam would have finished at 13½". 🧵 The scrunchie pattern uses ½" too, so this is consistent with how you sew.

Cut list ONE MAT

PIECE	CUT	NOTES
Front squares	9 × 5" × 5"	Mixed prints. Lay all nine out before sewing any.
Backing	13" × 13"	One piece. Cut it <i>after</i> the front, to the front's real size.
Interfacing	13" × 13"	Fused to the back of the front panel. Trim to 12" to lose bulk in the seam.
Turning gap	about 3"	Along one side, never a corner.

Order of work THE MAT

- Lay out the nine 3 × 3 and look at it. Move apart any print that repeats on a diagonal — this is the whole design decision and it takes a minute.
- Sew into three rows of three, ½" seams. Press each row's seams the opposite way to the row above so the joins nest.
- Join the three rows. The panel measures 13" × 13". If it doesn't, cut the backing to whatever it actually is.
- Fuse the interfacing to the wrong side of the pieced front. Press from the fabric side with a cloth.
- Front and backing right sides together. Sew all round at ½", leaving the 3" gap. Clip the four corners on the diagonal.
- Turn, poke the corners out, press hard. Turn the gap's raw edges in as you press so they sit level with the seam.
- Topstitch all round close to the edge — it closes the gap and it is what makes the edge crisp instead of puffy.

🧵 **Calculated, not measured:** a fat quarter yields 12 squares at 5" — one mat and three spare. 🧵 Nine 5" squares is what scraps are for, and 5" is charm-pack size, so a charm pack is a mat with change.

⚠️ **ONE QUESTION DECIDES HOW YOU MAY DESCRIBE THIS.** If "heat interfacing" means **fusible, iron-on interfacing**, it gives the mat **body, not heat protection** — a hot pot goes straight through to the table. Then it is a **decorative mat** and has to be sold as one. If it means **Insul-Bright or a heat-resistant batting**, it genuinely protects the table, and that is worth saying in the listing — it is the difference between a placemat and a trivet. **Tell me which and I will write it in.** 🧵

The cover STILL OPEN

WHAT	KNOWN	WRITE IT IN
Width × height	12" × 9"	
Patch grid, face	—	
Same 5" squares?	—	
Layers inside	—	
Hem binding width	—	

Layers inside the cover is the one that matters — it decides whether it keeps a pot warm. 🧵 **The mug rug sheet was written at 6" × 9" and had to be redone at the real 10" × 7½"**. Boxes, not guesses.

Selling it

SELL IT AS A NAMED SET, not two pieces. The ready-made cover was \$35; the mat was invoiced at \$35, which sits **under the published \$40 home-pieces floor**. Done once, fine — **not again**. Price the next matching piece at \$40, or price the pair as one set. ❌ **No band on this sheet on purpose** — the custom bands live in eight places and all eight change together.

Fabric: all five prints came off the **Tea with the Suriel shelf**. The set is the best argument that collection has. Photos: assets/home-suriel-tea-set.jpg and -2.jpg. 🧵 **Always shoot a cosy ON the pot.**